

Brad Lavender

Senior Platform / DevOps Engineer

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Summary

Senior Platform / DevOps Engineer with 9+ years of experience designing, automating, and operating cloud-native platforms with a strong Azure focus. Proven ability to build Infrastructure as Code, CI/CD systems, and internal developer platforms that reduce operational toil, improve deployment reliability, and scale across teams. Background as a full-stack developer with strong Go, C#, and TypeScript skills, enabling effective collaboration between infrastructure and application teams.

Experience

DevOps / Platform Engineer

Hunter Engineering Company — *July 2021 – Present*

Platform-focused DevOps role supporting enterprise architecture, internal development teams, and production systems across the organization.

- Designed and operated internal platform tooling and cloud infrastructure, with work split across platform engineering, developer enablement, and site reliability concerns.
 - Implemented Infrastructure as Code using Terraform, Pulumi, and Azure ARM/Bicep to standardize environment provisioning and reduce configuration drift.
 - Built and maintained CI/CD pipelines to support multiple application teams, improving deployment consistency and reducing manual release effort.
 - Implemented centralized monitoring, logging, and alerting using Datadog, Prometheus, Grafana, and Elastic, improving production visibility and incident response.
 - Partnered with application teams to improve build pipelines, deployment workflows, and operational readiness.
 - Optimized Azure resource utilization through monitoring-driven tuning and automation, contributing to reduced cloud costs and improved performance.
 - Acted as a trusted internal consultant for teams navigating cloud architecture, DevOps practices, and production issues.
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Application Software Developer (Backend / Platform-adjacent)

Centene Corporation — *February 2020 – July 2021*

Backend-focused development role within a large, highly regulated enterprise environment.

- Developed and maintained backend APIs in Go within a CI/CD-driven delivery model.
- Served as primary point of contact for an external reporting team during a major data migration from SQL Server to MongoDB.
- Built data pipelines using Kafka to move and transform data from relational databases into MongoDB collections.
- Tuned SQL stored procedures and audited MongoDB indexes to improve query performance and API responsiveness.
- Supported production API consumers and coordinated with multiple upstream and downstream teams in a large monolithic environment.
- Rapidly assimilated new technologies and internal tooling, becoming productive and independently handling tickets within two months.

Full Stack Web Developer

Motivation Technologies — *January 2017 – February 2020*

Full-stack developer in a small, fast-moving team delivering high-visibility marketing and promotional projects.

- Wrote and shipped the company's first React-based application.
- Delivered responsive web applications ranging from single-day promotional pages to multi-month projects exceeding \$250K in scope.
- Translated creative mockups into responsive, cross-browser implementations using TypeScript and modern JavaScript.
- Designed data models and implemented business rules driven by account and creative requirements.
- Built and maintained MVC systems, APIs, and SQL-backed data stores.
- Created automated and programmatic reporting solutions, ranging from one-off scripts to recurring multi-page reports.
- Gained early DevOps exposure through load balancing, deployment processes, and high-availability concepts.

Skills

Cloud & Platforms

- Microsoft Azure (Subscription Owner)
- Kubernetes
- Docker
- Kafka

Infrastructure as Code

- Terraform
- Pulumi
- Azure ARM / Bicep

CI/CD & Developer Experience

- Azure DevOps
- Jenkins
- GitHub Actions
- SonarQube
- Qwint AI

Observability & Reliability

- Datadog
- Prometheus
- Grafana
- Elastic Stack

Languages

- Go
- C#
- TypeScript / JavaScript
- PowerShell
- Java

APIs & Data

- REST, GraphQL, gRPC
- SQL Server
- MongoDB
- Postman, Swagger

AI & Automation

- GitHub Copilot
- Prompt Engineering
- AI-Assisted Development Workflows

Personal Interests

Hands-on and technical hobbies that reinforce problem-solving and systems thinking, including combat robotics, 3D printing and modeling, mechanical keyboards, woodworking, and outdoor activities such as rock climbing and slacklining.